

Nikita Sokolsky

Senior Software Engineer · 15 years of experience

Distributed systems · high-scale AWS infrastructure · LLM and agent systems

Seattle, WA · sokolx@gmail.com · +1 206 458 4791

www.linkedin.com/in/nsokolsky · github.com/SokolskyNikita · sokolsky.me

US Green Card holder, no sponsorship required · open to relocation anywhere in the US · available immediately

Summary

Backend and distributed systems engineer with 15 years in the industry, 8 of them at Amazon and AWS. Most recently owned read and write paths in the device data store that every Alexa device in the world reads from: hundreds of millions of endpoints, over 100,000 requests per second, single-digit-millisecond reads. That work included the scaling that let Alexa+, Amazon's generative-AI Alexa, ship. Before that, two years inside the AWS WAF request path, which evaluates customer security rules on billions of HTTP requests a day in every AWS region. Java, Rust, Go and Scala on the backend, React when the frontend needs it. Building with LLMs since mid-2022, before ChatGPT shipped. Certified Amazon Bar Raiser with 200+ interviews conducted and mentor to multiple SDEs. M.Sc. in Artificial Intelligence.

Experience

Career break · Apr 2026 – Jul 2026

Planned time off after eight years at Amazon, spent time building personal projects.

Amazon Web Services, Alexa AI · Seattle, WA

Software Development Engineer II, Alexa Device Intelligence · Nov 2024 – Apr 2026

Java, DynamoDB, Kinesis, Lambda, EC2

- Owned read and write paths in the DynamoDB-backed store that holds device state, configuration and session data for every Alexa device in the world: hundreds of millions of endpoints, over 100,000 requests per second sustained, single-digit-millisecond reads. Every Alexa interaction blocks on a read from this store. One of the largest stateful systems inside Amazon.
- Scaled the store for the launch of Alexa+, Amazon's generative-AI Alexa, which needed more throughput and tighter read latency than the original design allowed.
- Redesigned read and write access patterns across the DynamoDB services to take hot-partition risk out of the peak device-traffic path.
- Cut the team's on-call load by automating the runbooks and CloudWatch alarms for the failure modes that were waking people up.

Amazon Web Services, AWS WAF · Seattle, WA

Software Development Engineer II, AWS Web Application Firewall · Nov 2022 – Nov 2024

Java, Rust, Kafka, Kinesis, EC2

- Halved p50 latency and raised throughput in the WAF request-processing pipeline, which enforces customer security rules on billions of HTTP and HTTPS requests a day in every AWS region.
- Cut the service fleet to a third of its size by moving the rule-evaluation engine's hottest component from Java to Rust. Profiling ruled out the cheaper fixes first, and the team took over the component once I had written the design review and walked them through the code.
- Built and operated the Kafka (MSK) and Kinesis pipelines carrying real-time rule telemetry and customer log delivery.
- Drove capacity planning and load-shedding strategy with the org's principal engineers to hold sub-millisecond rule-evaluation SLAs at peak traffic.

Flexport · Seattle, WA

Senior Software Engineer, Freight Forwarding Platform · Feb 2022 – Nov 2022

Scala, PostgreSQL (RDS), React

- Led design and delivery of the freight forwarding application that more than 2,000 Flexport cargo operators work in every day to move customer shipments.
- Replaced a legacy monolith with event-driven Scala services on PostgreSQL (RDS), and drew the service boundaries and event contracts myself. Migrated one workflow at a time so operators kept working through the cutover. Reliability and deploy cadence both improved.
- Built the React frontend with product and design, and got operators through the same work in fewer steps than the tool it replaced.

Amazon Web Services, Networking · Seattle, WA

Software Development Engineer, AWS Networking · May 2021 – Feb 2022

Go, ECS, Lambda

- Founding engineer on the service that launched as [Amazon CloudWatch Internet Monitor](#), which scores internet availability and performance for customer workloads on AWS, broken down by client location and ISP.
- Designed the monitoring backend as event-driven Go services on Lambda and ECS, with automatic failover between regions.
- Owned it from the first design document through operational runbooks and Amazon's internal launch review to release.

Amazon, Business Payments · Seattle, WA

Software Development Engineer, Amazon Business Payments · May 2019 – May 2021

Java, EC2, Lambda

- Led the multi-year architectural refactor of invoice generation for Amazon Business, then a roughly \$25B-a-year gross-sales business, and wrote most of the replacement pipeline myself.
- Broke a brittle monolithic billing pipeline into independently deployable services, each with its own metrics and alarms, so one failing step stopped taking the whole pipeline with it and the team's on-call load dropped.
- Added regression-test automation and monitoring dashboards that let the team ship billing changes without a manual verification pass.

Amazon, Business Credit · Vancouver, BC

Software Development Engineer, Amazon Business Credit Card · Jan 2018 – May 2019

Java, Spring, React, EC2, Lambda

- Delivered the Amazon Business credit card for small businesses, a partnership with American Express, on schedule in late 2018.
- Owned both sides of the product: the React frontend customers apply and manage the card in, and the backend REST APIs behind it.
- Wrote the UI and backend integration test suites from scratch.

Earlier experience

- **Moravia** · Brno, Czech Republic · Oct 2017 – Jan 2018. Software Development Consultant (C#, .NET, MVC). Built new workflow features and reliability fixes in an enterprise SaaS platform for corporate translation management.
- **ArexPharma GmbH** · Munich, Germany · Jun 2017 – Oct 2017. Software Development Consultant (C#, .NET, MVC). Rebuilt supplier workflows in a B2B marketplace for cross-border pharmaceutical trade in the EU.
- **ACTUM Digital** · Prague, Czech Republic · Nov 2016 – May 2017. Software Developer (Sitecore, C#, .NET). Delivered enterprise client websites and production warranty support.
- **Creditinfo Solutions** · Prague, Czech Republic · Apr 2013 – Oct 2016. Software Developer, internal platforms (C#, .NET, SQL Server, Dynamics CRM). Owned the Dynamics CRM integration layer serving the company's global offices, working with product managers across several European locations.
- **moodAway** · London, UK, remote · Jun 2015 – Sep 2015. Built AngularJS frontend features.

- **Internships and freelance:** University of Paderborn GET Lab, Germany (2012), algorithms for the GetBot autonomous rescue robot · Lappeenranta University of Technology, Finland (2013) · freelance web app for visual analysis of commercial websites (2011).

Technical skills

- **Languages:** Java, Rust, Go, Scala, TypeScript, C#/.NET, SQL
- **AWS:** DynamoDB, Kinesis, MSK (Kafka), Lambda, EC2, ECS, S3, RDS, Elasticsearch, CloudWatch
- **Systems:** Distributed systems, event-driven architecture, stream processing, microservices, REST API design, capacity planning, load shedding, observability, on-call operations
- **AI systems:** LLM application design, agent harnesses and orchestration, MCP servers, RAG, context engineering
- **Data stores:** DynamoDB, PostgreSQL, SQL Server, Cloudflare D1
- **Frontend:** React, TypeScript, AngularJS
- **Delivery:** CI/CD, GitHub Actions, automated testing, Cloudflare Workers
- **Spoken languages:** English, Russian and Czech, fluent in all three

Projects

sokolsky.me · May 2026 – present

- Personal site that has become my personal SaaS: tools built for my own needs, including a custom flight search engine and a custom hotel search engine. Full list at sokolsky.me/sitemap.
- 90 pages in ten weeks, built with heavy coding-agent assistance.

rankmyweather.com · July 2026

- Ranks world cities by how the weather actually feels outdoors. Five years of ERA5 hourly reanalysis, 1,826 days on a 0.25° global grid, reduced to daily Steadman apparent temperature and scored per urban center, behind an interactive map.

Recognition and mentoring

Amazon Bar Raiser. Certified to hold Amazon's hiring bar across all technical disciplines. 200+ interviews conducted, up to principal and senior principal level, across several AWS organizations.

Mentoring. Mentored multiple SDEs at Amazon and AWS over five years.

Education

M.Sc. in Artificial Intelligence · Czech Technical University in Prague · 2015 – 2017

B.Sc. in Computer Software Engineering · Czech Technical University in Prague · 2011 – 2014